RealEstate EthioAmerica website: go-live and admin guide

This folder is the complete website. It has no monthly software cost: it runs on Netlify's free plan, and the admin panel (Decap CMS) is free and open source. You only pay for a domain name (about $15–20 a year).

What's in the folder

Folder or file	What it is
`index.html`	The website (all pages)
`content/`	All the words, links and settings. The admin panel edits these files for you
`img/`	Photos and magazine pages. New uploads go to `img/uploads/`
`admin/`	The admin panel, at `yoursite.com/admin/`
`netlify.toml`	Hosting settings. Leave it as is

Part 1: Put the site live (one time, about 45 minutes)

You need: a free GitHub account, a free Netlify account, and later your domain.

1. **Create a GitHub repository.** Sign up at github.com, click **New repository**, name it `realestate-ethioamerica`, choose **Private**, and create it.
2. **Upload the files.** In the new repository click **uploading an existing file**, then drag in *everything inside* this folder (not the folder itself), including the `admin`, `content` and `img` folders. Click **Commit changes**.
3. **Connect Netlify.** Sign up at netlify.com with your GitHub account. Click **Add new site → Import an existing project → GitHub**, pick the repository, leave the build settings empty, and click **Deploy**. In about a minute you get a live address like `something.netlify.app`.
4. **Turn on the admin login.**
5. In Netlify open your site → **Project configuration → Identity → Enable Identity**.
6. Under **Registration**, choose **Invite only**.
7. Under **Services → Git Gateway**, click **Enable Git Gateway**.
8. Go to the **Identity** tab and click **Invite users**. Invite yourself and Binyam by email.

9. **Accept the invite.** Open the email, click the link, set a password. You land in the admin panel. From now on log in at `yoursite.com/admin/`.
10. **Connect your domain.** Buy the domain once you've settled the name (cover vs back cover). In Netlify go to **Domain management** → **Add a domain** and follow the steps. Netlify adds free HTTPS automatically.
11. **Turn on the forms.** In the admin panel open **Site settings**, tick **Turn on website forms**, untick **Show the preview banner**, and publish. Then in Netlify go to **Forms** → **Form notifications** and add an email notification so every inquiry lands in your inbox. Netlify's free plan has a monthly submission limit; check your plan in the Netlify dashboard.

> If the Identity option is not available on your account, the fallback is to log in with GitHub instead: in `admin/config.yml` change `name: git-gateway` to `name: github` and add a line `repo: YOUR-GITHUB-NAME/realestate-ethioamerica`. Each editor then needs a GitHub account with access to the repository.

Part 2: Using the admin panel

Log in at `yoursite.com/admin/`. You'll see four sections on the left:

Section	What you change there
Advertisers	Every developer, bank, attorney, architect, insurance agent and US agent: name, text, ad images, facts, areas, contact buttons, featured on home page, and the date their package ends
News	Stories for the News page, and the Coming Soon list
Magazine issue	The current issue's page images, table of contents, flipbook link and PDF, plus past issues
Site settings	Home page cover photo and headline (English and Amharic), disclaimers, contact channels, publishers, ad packages and prices

How saving works: you edit, click **Save** (a draft), then open the **Workflow** tab and move the card to **Ready**, then **Publish**. The live site updates about a minute later. Nothing goes live by accident.

Pictures: click any image field, then **Upload**. Use JPGs under about 500 KB; magazine pages around 1000 pixels tall look sharp and load fast.

An advertiser's package ended: their profile hides itself automatically after the **Ad package ends on** date. To hide one early, untick **Show on website**.

Part 3: Quarterly update checklist

Do this when each new issue comes out.

- ☐ **Magazine issue:** move the current issue into **Past issues** (title, cover, flipbook link, PDF).
- ☐ **Magazine issue:** set the new title (e.g. "Issue 02 · April 2027"), upload the new page images in order, update the table of contents, add the Flipsnack link and PDF.
- ☐ **Site settings → Home page cover:** new cover photo, issue label and headline, in English and Amharic.
- ☐ **Advertisers:** add new advertisers (only after they've given you every document on the Listing Standards list), update returning ones with their new ad image, and set each package's end date.
- ☐ **Advertisers:** tick **Featured** for the developers on this issue's Feature package (up to 4 show on the home page).
- ☐ **News:** add 2–3 new stories, mark any paid story as **Sponsored**, refresh the Coming Soon list.
- ☐ **Words check:** search every new text for verified, vetted, guaranteed, trusted, certified, approved, risk-free, safe investment, "we sell", "our listings". Replace them (see the table below).
- ☐ **Look at the live site on your phone** before you share the link.

Words to avoid, and what to use instead

Avoid	Use instead
Verified, vetted, certified, approved	Selected, featured, advertiser-provided
Guaranteed, risk-free, safe investment	Advertised terms, according to the advertiser
Trusted, recommended, endorsed, best	Featured developer, selected advertiser
We sell, we broker, our listings, buy through us	Contact the advertiser directly
Commission, referral fee	Flat advertising fee

Before launch, still to do

- Attorney review of the disclaimers, Privacy Policy and Terms of Use (placeholders are on the Disclaimer page).
- Your translator reviews all Amharic text.
- Confirm each advertiser's phone, email and facts with them.
- Add your contact email, WhatsApp and Telegram channel links in **Site settings**.
- Ask Peg whether your KW name and license should appear anywhere.